

SEO AUDIT REPORT

backlinko.com

Backlinko.com is a leading SEO and digital marketing authority site founded by Brian Dean. This audit evaluates the site across on-page optimisation, technical health, content strategy, backlink profile, and user experience. The site demonstrates exceptional content quality and brand authority, with primary improvement opportunities in technical infrastructure, mobile page speed, and structured data implementation.

Prepared by Farhan Siddique	Date May 2026	Type Full-Site SEO Analysis	Classification Confidential
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72 /100 Overall Score	85 /100 On-Page SEO	61 /100 Technical SEO	78 /100 Content Quality	55 /100 Backlink Profile
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01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CATEGORY	STATUS	PRIORITY	IMPACT
On-Page SEO	GOOD	LOW	Stable rankings, strong keyword targeting
Technical SEO	FAIR	MEDIUM	Mobile speed & Core Web Vitals require attention
Content Strategy	GOOD	LOW	Traffic retention, content depth strong
Backlink Profile	NEEDS WORK	HIGH	Net-negative link velocity over 90 days
User Experience	FAIR	MEDIUM	Mobile CLS exceeds threshold, bounce rate elevated
Mobile Optimisation	GOOD	LOW	Mobile rankings maintained despite speed gaps

This audit evaluates backlinko.com across five core dimensions: on-page optimisation, technical SEO health, content strategy, backlink profile quality, and mobile user experience. All findings are manually reviewed and prioritised by business impact.

02 ON-PAGE SEO ANALYSIS

2.1 Element Assessment

ELEMENT	STATUS	NOTES
Title Tags	OPTIMIZED	Keyword-first, correct length throughout
Meta Descriptions	MOSTLY GOOD	~12% pages missing unique descriptions
Header Tags (H1–H3)	OPTIMIZED	Clear hierarchy maintained across all pages
Keyword Placement	OPTIMIZED	Natural density, zero keyword stuffing detected
Image Alt Text	PARTIAL	~20% of images missing alt attributes
Internal Linking	STRONG	Deep interlinking across all blog content
URL Structure	OPTIMIZED	Short, keyword-rich, clean slugs throughout
Canonical Tags	PRESENT	Correctly implemented site-wide — no duplication

2.2 Content & Keyword Assessment

Backlinko's title tags are precisely crafted with primary keywords at the front and follow the recommended 50–60 character limit. Meta descriptions are compelling with clear value propositions. Approximately 12% of blog posts use duplicate or auto-generated meta descriptions — addressable with a targeted content audit. Content is regarded as the gold standard in the SEO industry. Articles are data-driven, long-form (averaging 2,500+ words), and exhaustively researched. Content freshness is a minor concern: 15+ high-traffic posts have not been updated in 12–18 months and are at risk of ranking decay.

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TECHNICAL SEO ANALYSIS

3.1 Core Web Vitals

METRIC	DESKTOP	MOBILE	TARGET	STATUS
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	1.9s	3.8s	< 2.5s	FAIL
FID (First Input Delay)	12ms	45ms	< 100ms	PASS
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	0.04	0.11	< 0.10	FAIL
TTFB (Time to First Byte)	0.4s	0.8s	< 0.6s	WARN
Speed Index	2.1s	4.2s	< 3.4s	FAIL

3.2 Crawlability, Indexation & Schema

Mobile page speed is the most critical technical concern. Core Web Vitals analysis reveals LCP averaging 3.8s on mobile — significantly above Google's 2.5s threshold. Key contributors include render-blocking JavaScript, uncompressed images, and third-party script overhead. Desktop performance is strong. The robots.txt is correctly configured and an XML sitemap is submitted to Google Search Console. Four URLs were found using 302 temporary redirects instead of 301 permanent redirects — this leaks link equity and should be corrected immediately. Schema markup implementation is limited: Article schema is present on blog posts, but FAQ schema, HowTo schema, and BreadcrumbList schema are absent.

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BACKLINK PROFILE ANALYSIS

METRIC	VALUE	BENCHMARK	ASSESSMENT
Domain Authority (est.)	76/100	Top 5% of all sites	STRONG
Total Referring Domains	~18,400	Industry leader	STRONG
New Links (Last 90 days)	~340	Declining trend	CONCERN
Lost Links (Last 90 days)	~510	Net negative (–170)	WARNING

METRIC	VALUE	BENCHMARK	ASSESSMENT
Toxic / Spammy Links	~2%	< 5% acceptable	PASS
Anchor Text Diversity	High	Natural distribution	GOOD
Dofollow / Nofollow Ratio	82% / 18%	60–80% dofollow target	GOOD

PRIORITY ISSUES & RECOMMENDATIONS

PRI.	AREA	FINDING	RECOMMENDATION
HIGH	Page Speed	Mobile LCP 3.8s exceeds Google's 2.5s threshold — multiple key pages affected	Compress images to WebP format, defer non-critical JavaScript, enable browser caching, preload critical LCP elements
HIGH	Link Velocity	Net negative link velocity over last 90 days — 170 more links lost than gained	Launch digital PR campaign; create linkable assets such as original studies, tools, and infographics to attract editorial links
HIGH	Schema Markup	No FAQ, HowTo, or BreadcrumbList schema present on any high-traffic pages	Implement FAQ schema on top 20 posts; add BreadcrumbList schema site-wide; add HowTo schema to tutorial content
MEDIUM	Alt Text	~20% of images are missing descriptive alt attributes across the blog	Audit all images via Screaming Frog; add keyword-relevant, descriptive alt text to every untagged image
MEDIUM	302 Redirects	4 URLs using temporary 302 redirects instead of permanent 301 redirects	Convert all 302 redirects to 301 to preserve full link equity transfer to destination pages
MEDIUM	Content Freshness	15+ high-traffic posts have not been updated in 12–18 months — ranking decay risk	Schedule quarterly content refreshes for all top 20 organic traffic pages; update stats and examples
MEDIUM	CLS Mobile	Mobile CLS of 0.11 exceeds the 0.10 threshold on several key pages	Reserve fixed pixel dimensions for ad slots and image containers; eliminate all layout shift triggers
LOW	Meta Descriptions	~12% of pages are missing unique, compelling meta descriptions	Write unique meta descriptions for all top-100 organic traffic pages, prioritising those with highest impressions
LOW	Voice Search	Limited FAQ-style content targeting voice and conversational search queries	Add question-based H2/H3 headers with concise 40–60 word direct-answer sections to top-performing posts

90-DAY ACTION PLAN

PHASE 1 — DAYS 1–30 | Quick Wins

- Convert all 302 redirects to 301 redirects — preserves full link equity immediately
- Add descriptive alt text to all images identified as missing attributes across the blog
- Write unique meta descriptions for the top 100 organic traffic pages
- Implement BreadcrumbList schema across all blog category and post pages
- Enable image compression and convert all images to WebP format

PHASE 2 — DAYS 31–60 | Technical Fixes

- Defer non-critical JavaScript and eliminate all render-blocking resources
- Implement FAQ schema on the top 20 highest-traffic blog posts
- Fix CLS issues on mobile — reserve fixed dimensions for ad and dynamic content blocks
- Improve TTFB through server-side caching and CDN optimisation
- Audit and improve internal linking on all pre-2020 content

PHASE 3 — DAYS 61–90 | Growth & Authority

- Publish an original data-driven industry study to generate editorial backlinks at scale
- Launch podcast guest outreach campaign targeting high-authority SEO publications
- Refresh the top 15 high-traffic posts with updated statistics and expanded sections
- Add question-based headings to top 20 posts targeting featured snippet positions
- Build 2–3 free tools or calculators as permanent linkable assets

TOOLS & METHODOLOGY

TOOL	PURPOSE
Google Analytics / Search Console	Traffic data, keyword rankings, indexation status
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Technical crawl — redirects, alt text, broken links, meta tags
PageSpeed Insights	Core Web Vitals — LCP, CLS, FID, TTFB measurements
Semrush / Ahrefs (Reference Data)	Backlink profile, domain authority, referring domains
Schema.org Validator	Structured data verification and rich result eligibility
Manual Content Review	Content quality, keyword strategy, UX and readability

Farhan Siddique

Digital Marketer & Data Analyst

HubSpot · Google · Microsoft Certified

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**SEO Audits · Excel Dashboards · Email Marketing ·
Social Media**
